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Everyday Holiness

Week 5 · Charisms & Your Mission

After the hard work of the fault, this week is pure good news. God deposited specific gifts in you -- on purpose, for the people around you. This week you learn to see gifts operating that you have been dismissing as just personality your whole life, and you stop burying them out of fear.

A TALENT VS A CHARISM

A talent is something you do well. A charism is something God does through you, for someone else. The difference is not the skill -- it is the source, and who it is for. When you explain something and a person understands in a way your skill alone does not account for, something came through you from beyond you. That is the Holy Spirit. That is a charism.

+ *"Each has received a gift, use it to serve one another." -- 1 Peter 4:10*

HOW CHARISMS ARE CONFIRMED

You do not identify your charisms by guessing which sound impressive. They are confirmed in community -- other people tell you something shifted in them. 'When you prayed for me, something lifted.' 'When you explained that, I finally understood.' Look backward: what do people keep thanking you for? The things that feel effortless to you are often exactly where your charisms live -- you discount them precisely because they cost you nothing.

WEEK 5 *E -- Election*

+ *"Choose this day whom you will serve." -- Joshua 24:15*

Election is the daily choice that quietly becomes a life. Using a gift you have been burying is an election. Saying the true thing instead of staying safely silent is an election. This week you choose to spend what God gave you, one small brave choice at a time.

MORNING REFLECTION · WEEK 5

What do people keep thanking you for -- especially things so easy for you that you assume they are nothing?

Has anyone recently told you something shifted in them because of you? Write what they said.

Name your gifts as best you can right now. What has God put in you for the people around you?

"The things that feel effortless to you are often exactly where your charisms live."

THE PARABLE OF THE TALENTS

One servant buries what he was given. Notice his reason -- not laziness, not malice. 'I was afraid, so I hid it.' Fear is what buries a gift: fear of getting it wrong, of being too much, of being seen, of the responsibility a gift carries. And burying it often looks like humility -- 'I'm not really that gifted.' But that is fear wearing humility's clothes. True humility knows exactly what it was given and holds it with open hands.

Which of your gifts are you burying right now -- and what is the fear underneath it?

Where does burying a gift show up in you as false humility -- 'let someone else do it'?

What would it mean to believe God gave you these gifts on purpose, and expects you to spend them?

YOUR GIFTS ARE A MISSION

Your mission is not overseas. It is the specific people God has already put in front of you -- your spouse, your children, the friend barely holding on, the woman new to your parish. Your charisms are the exact tools for the exact people in your actual life. You do not have to be more than you are. You have to stop burying what you already are, and spend it on the people God already gave you.

Who are the specific people your gifts are meant for? Name them, and name what you could give.

BRIDGE THOUGHT · WEEK 5

I am a branch, not the Vine. I bear fruit by remaining, not by straining. One faithful election at a time. -- Write your own, or make this one yours.

THIS WEEK'S PRACTICE

Spend one buried gift, once, on purpose this week -- for God's eyes, not for applause. Say the true thing. Offer to pray out loud. Step into what you keep avoiding out of fear. You will feel the old fear; do it anyway. That is the Turn, and you already know how.

GIFT SPENT · ELECTION MADE	S	M	T	W	T	F	S

+ *"A gift spent in love is never diminished -- it multiplies." -- cf. Luke 6:38*